

Feedback Survey: Training Workshop on Data Science and AI Tools for Beginners

30 September 2026 · Bayes Business School, City St George's, University of London

Thank you for attending the workshop. This survey takes about 10 minutes. It consists of the following sections:

- About you
- Overall experience
- Preparation
- Workshop sessions
- Outcomes and impact
- Looking ahead
- Closing

Your feedback will be used to improve future workshops and may be used to support applications for funding to organise similar events. Anonymous summaries may be shared with prospective attendees/funders.

Note: This survey is anonymous unless you let us contact you for follow-ups on your feedback and provide your name and email address for this purpose at the end of survey.

Section A. About you

1. What is your affiliation?

- ☐ SENSS
- ☐ SeNSS
- ☐ Unfunded student of a SENSS/SeNSS institution
- ☐ Student of another ESRC-funded Doctoral Training Partnership (DTP)
- ☐ Other

2. What is your year of study in your PhD programme?

- ☐ First year
- ☐ Second year
- ☐ Third year
- ☐ Fourth year or later

3. Before the workshop, how much experience did you have with the tools/techniques covered?

- ☐ None at all
- ☐ Had heard of them but never tried
- ☐ Had tried a few times
- ☐ Used some of them regularly
- ☐ Used most of them regularly

Section B. Overall experience

4. How did you find the level of the content covered in the Workshop relative to what was advertised on its webpage (<https://drayim.github.io/TrainingWorkshop/>)?

- ☐ Much more basic than advertised
- ☐ Slightly more basic than advertised
- ☐ As advertised
- ☐ Slightly more advanced than advertised
- ☐ Much more advanced than advertised

5. How did you find the overall pace of the day?

- ☐ Much too slow
- ☐ A little too slow
- ☐ About right
- ☐ A little too fast
- ☐ Much too fast

6. Overall, how would you rate the workshop?

- ☐ Excellent
- ☐ Good
- ☐ Average
- ☐ Poor
- ☐ Very poor

7. How likely are you to recommend this workshop to a fellow PhD student? (0 = not at all likely, 10 = extremely likely)

- ☐ 0 (not at all likely)
- ☐ 1
- ☐ 2
- ☐ 3
- ☐ 4
- ☐ 5
- ☐ 6
- ☐ 7
- ☐ 8
- ☐ 9
- ☐ 10 (extremely likely)

8. What would you tell a PhD student who is considering joining another run of this workshop?

Section C. Preparation

9. How much time did you spend on the preliminary self-learning materials and account setup before the workshop?

- ☐ No more than 2 hours
- ☐ Up to 5 hours (but above 2 hours)
- ☐ Up to 8 hours (but above 5 hours)
- ☐ Up to 11 hours (but above 8 hours)
- ☐ Over 11 hours

10. Which, if any, of the following setup steps caused you difficulty? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ GitHub Education account / Student Developer Pack verification
- ☐ GitHub Codespaces
- ☐ [Lightning.ai](#) account
- ☐ Posit Cloud / RStudio
- ☐ No major difficulties

11. The preliminary self-learning materials prepared me well for the workshop.

- ☐ Strongly agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Neutral
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Strongly disagree

12. Which, if any, of the following should be excluded from the list of preliminary self-learning materials? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ WorkshopPreliminaries (up to p. 17)
- ☐ GitHubAccount-Repo-Copilot-Codespace_Setup_Instructions (up to section 5)
- ☐ Jupyter_PythonBasics+.ipynb
- ☐ WorkshopPreliminaries (p. 18 to the end)
- ☐ RStudioPreparations
- ☐ ResultTables
- ☐ Lightning.aiAccount_Setup_Instructions
- ☐ None of these

13. Which, if any, of the following should be significantly revised to improve clarity? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ WorkshopPreliminaries (up to p. 17)
- ☐ GitHubAccount-Repo-Copilot-Codespace_Setup_Instructions (up to section 5)
- ☐ Jupyter_PythonBasics+.ipynb
- ☐ WorkshopPreliminaries (p. 18 to the end)
- ☐ RStudioPreparations
- ☐ ResultTables
- ☐ Lightning.aiAccount_Setup_Instructions
- ☐ None of these

Section D. Workshop sessions

14. How useful was each session of the workshop

	Very useful	Useful	Neutral	Of limited use	Not useful	I did not attend this session
GitHub ecosystem and marimo (web scraping, web crawling, document processing)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Getting AI assistance (GitHub Copilot and agentic tools such as OpenCode)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
GPU-accelerated NLP (Lightning.ai)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
R ecosystem and Q&A (including identifying useful packages on GitHub)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

15. Which sessions did you feel needed more time? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ GitHub ecosystem and marimo
- ☐ Getting AI assistance
- ☐ GPU-accelerated NLP
- ☐ R ecosystem and Q&A
- ☐ None, the time allocation was about right

16. What was the single most useful thing you learned or tried during the workshop?

17. What, if anything, should be added, removed or changed in the content?

Section E. Outcomes and impact

18. Without this workshop, could you have accessed comparable training?

- ☐ Yes, easily
- ☐ Yes, but with difficulty or at a significant cost
- ☐ Probably not
- ☐ Not sure

19. Looking back, how confident were you **BEFORE** the workshop in using tools such as Python, R, GitHub and AI assistants for your research?

- ☐ Very confident
- ☐ Fairly confident
- ☐ Somewhat confident
- ☐ Not very confident
- ☐ Not at all confident

20. How confident do you feel **NOW** in starting to use these tools independently in your research?

- ☐ Very confident
- ☐ Fairly confident
- ☐ Somewhat confident
- ☐ Not very confident
- ☐ Not at all confident

21. Which of the following tools/techniques do you expect to use in your research within the next six months? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ GitHub repositories
- ☐ GitHub Codespace, [Lightning.ai](#) Studio, or cloud computing environments
- ☐ GitHub Copilot
- ☐ OpenCode or another agentic AI tool (other than GitHub Copilot)
- ☐ Python
- ☐ R
- ☐ marimo notebooks
- ☐ Web scraping/crawling
- ☐ Document processing
- ☐ NLP
- ☐ LLM access via API
- ☐ None of these

22. What are the main barriers to starting/continuing to use the tools/techniques covered in the workshop? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ Lack of time
- ☐ Need further training or support
- ☐ Cost of AI tools or computing
- ☐ Concerns about AI use from my supervisor or department
- ☐ Institutional restrictions (e.g., ethics, data or software policies)
- ☐ Tools not relevant to my research
- ☐ No major barriers
- ☐ Other

23. Overall, do you consider this workshop to be useful to the future development of your research capability and productivity?

- ☐ Extremely useful
- ☐ Very useful
- ☐ Moderately useful
- ☐ Slightly useful
- ☐ Not useful at all

Section F. Looking ahead

24. How likely would you be to attend a follow-up workshop?

- ☐ Definitely
- ☐ Probably
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ Probably not
- ☐ Definitely not

25. What level should a follow-up workshop target?

- ☐ Intermediate level, building on the tools/techniques of this workshop
- ☐ Same beginner level on other tools/techniques
- ☐ Intermediate level on other tools/techniques

26. What format would you prefer for a follow-up?

- ☐ One-day, in person
- ☐ Two-day, in person
- ☐ Several half-day sessions in person
- ☐ Live online sessions

27. What topics would you want a follow-up workshop to cover?

28. Any other suggestions or comments?

Section G. Closing

29. May we quote your comments anonymously in promotional materials/funding applications?

- ☐ Yes, in promotional materials/funding applications
- ☐ Yes, but only in promotional materials
- ☐ Yes, but only in funding applications
- ☐ No

30. Are you happy to be contacted for follow-ups on your suggestions/comments?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

31. Please provide your name and email address if you answer yes in the previous question.

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